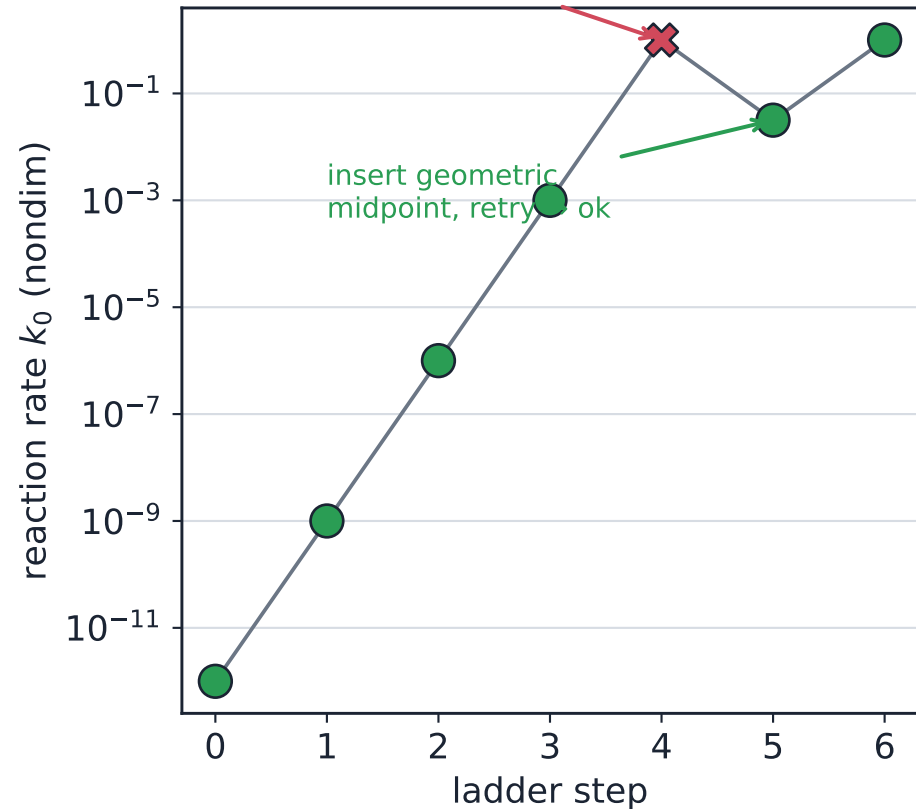
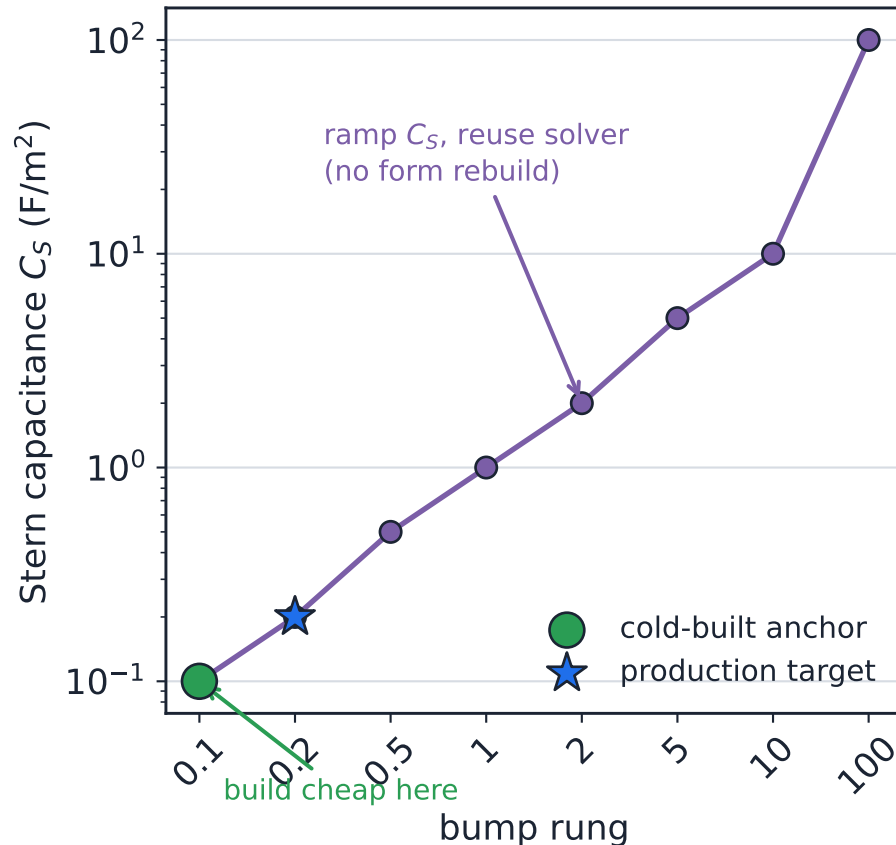


# Defense in depth: never solve the hard problem cold — deform into it

## 1 · $k_0$ continuation (real ladder, $\sqrt{k_0}$ -midpoint recovery)



## 2 · Stern bump ladder (0.10 → 0.20 → ... → 100)



## 3 · grid walk + cliff warm-walk (recursive bisection across $V \approx 0$ )

